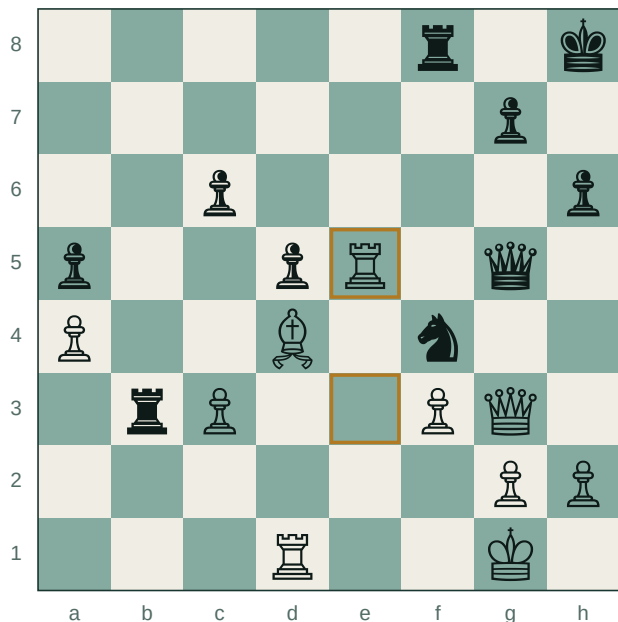


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 34

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 34.Re5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34...Qxe5 35. Bxe5 Ne2+ 36. Kf2 Nxd3

34...Qxe5 The queen captures the rook on e5. Recorded reply: **35.Bxe5**.

35...Ne2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From e2 it attacks king on g1 and queen on g3. Recorded reply: **36.Kf2**.

36...Nxd3 The knight captures the queen on g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on d1. Check for tactical protection.